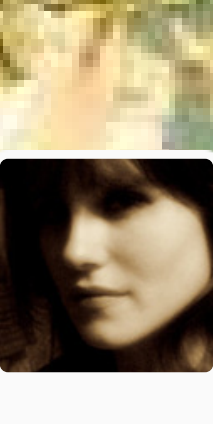

A Brie Grows in Brooklyn

"Mabel's not crazy... she's unusual."

The Preview of This Should Scare Family Members Away From Reading Further

I 1,000% should not be writing this on the Internet, but Caleb and I still have not had sex yet after Cass was torn from a hole in my abdomen. Shit started getting a little squirrley down there, like literally — my vagina looked like a squirrel — so I finally shaved the hair around the incision scar this weekend. After the MRSA, I have been afraid to even brush over the scar with

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finding a section of it torn open and eeking o many times in the six months postpartum. ("My body is a horror show" sung to the tune "My body is a wonderland" by John Mayer.) But something the hippies don't tell you is that left untamed, pubic hair starts to smell. I shaved off my pubic hair, and found that both the two inches of skin below the scar, and the two inches above the scar, are still completely numb.

The scar, however, is white and clean, with the sections where the MSRA busted open still pink. I emerged from the shower feeling great about my body. I stopped weighing myself, but my clothing size hasn't changed, so I assume I haven't lost any weight. After flirting with various diets, I've gone back to a diet of eating what I feel like peppered throughout with doses of sugar. Human beings have invented many wonderful things, among them chocolate chip cookies, and anyone who tells you not to eat them is fucking stupid. Except, I guess, if you have diabetes. But really.

My Uncle M taught me two things in this life. How to give a blow job on a hair brush, and how exercise fills your body with endorphins, which make you feel better about the way you look. I wake up every day at 5am, and think to myself, "Why am I about to go work out like a maniac?" Only to find the answer in the midst of a set of mountain climbers, while sweat drips down my face, and I feel, deep in my core, the strength to pick up my pace. I see my body in the mirror, and I see the curve of my ass, and the breasts that I got from breastfeeding, and I'm like, "Damn G!" Even despite the skin flap that hangs down my c-section incision like a…honestly, it reminds me of the pig skin I cut off a pork shoulder when I made a pernil in the Instapot a few weeks ago.

Yesterday, Caleb was walking way faster than me down the street, and with minimal effort, I revved up my pace, and caught up to him. "Thank you, thunder thighs," I thanked my thigh muscles, which have been strengthening.

Back to not having sex with Caleb. Having sex with him would require us to like plan it out, because Cass still sleeps on me for about 14 hours a day, leaving me with very little bodily freedom. When Caleb gets into bed at night, Cass and I are asleep, wrapped in a loving embrace. Cass props his little feet on my thigh, claiming ownership.

HAMMER SMASH &

Lately, I have been appreciating Caleb in new ways. Yes, he makes a big show every time he has to poop, and often acts like a dictator when I try to look at my phone when we're watching television. Yes, he made pancakes on Friday morning, and then left for work without cleaning any of the dishes. But we really enjoy spending time together. The past two weekends, we have gone on afternoon dates. The first afternoon, we went out to a late lunch, and then rode our bikes to Valentino Pier to watch the sun set. This past Sunday, we went to Coney Island to ride roller coasters.

LUNA PARK
CONEY ISLAND
THUNDERBOLT

The first roller coaster we rode was the Cyclone, and we screamed with joy the entire time.

The second roller coaster had an entirely vertical section. We sat in a row of three next to a puffy-looking teenage boy. "Have you been on the Cyclone yet?" Caleb asked him when the ride was over.

"Yeah," the boy said.

"It's even scarier than this, right?"

The boy looked at him with watery blue eyes. "You were screaming the entire ride," he said to Caleb.

We couldn't stop giggling, our arms around each other, as we wove our way through the grime of the park, stopping to play games run by elderly women smoking cigarettes and drinking coffee so that we could bring home some presents for Cleo.

It seems impossible to me that I could love him anything but more the more time we spend together as a family. What I'm saying is, we'll have sex again. Sex feels important, but it also feels like something we have time for, because I want to be with Caleb forever.

Lately, I have visions of my own death frequently, if only because I feel so lucky, I just know someone is going to take it all away from me. Give me depression, Lord, instead, please.

Two weeks ago, I wrote about moving to the suburbs. In that time, my sister has threatened me, and sent me legal actions letting me know her intention to sue me for defamation in court. She blames me for everything that has gone wrong in her life. All of this has made Caleb and I seriously reconsider moving to the suburbs. Living near to my sister, when she lived near us in Brooklyn, was akin to living in a war zone. Moving back near her would be willfully submitting to insanity. I'm growing older, Lord. I'm learning. I'm getting better. I know this isn't a good idea.

Instead, we're talking again about Savannah, where we frequently are our most happy. Caleb, if we lived there, would have even more time to spend with us. His family is there. Our two best friends are there. We could have a good life.

But could I leave all of this dysfunction? My mother? My father? My other siblings? The rage that is my New York birthright? Winter, which I love? The friends I've had since first grade?

I am getting bored writing this post so I'm just going to say, I wish that the future were clear.

#My life #Motherhood

4 notes Oct 15th, 2019

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